

World of Warcraft: AI-Buddy

My name is Rasmus Ploug, a master's student studying Game Development and Learning Technology at the University of Southern Denmark. I'm currently in my 9th semester, and I'm working on a research project about the future of AI-driven NPCs in World of Warcraft. With the latest expansion, The War Within, we've seen a shift towards more single-player-focused content for casual players, like Follower-Dungeons and Delves. My goal is to explore how LLM-driven NPCs (powered by advanced language models like ChatGPT) could enhance player experiences in these and other areas of the game.

To do this, I've created this questionnaire aimed at understanding what features WoW players would find most relevant or irrelevant in AI companions. Your feedback will help shape practical guidelines for integrating these LLM-driven NPCs in future content.

Why participate?

You'll be contributing to research that could influence the future of NPCs in games!
You'll get a chance to voice your opinion on what makes AI companions fun, useful, or even annoying.

As a thank you, I'm giving away **2x WoW Tokens**—one for NA and one for EU—randomly to participants who complete the survey!

If you have a few minutes to spare, I'd really appreciate your input. Your insights will be invaluable to my research.

* Indicates required question

1. What is your gender? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Male
- ☐ Female
- ☐ Other
- ☐ Prefer not to say

2. In which region do you play? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Americas & Oceania (US & OCE)
- ☐ Europe (EU)
- ☐ China (CN)
- ☐ Korea (KR)
- ☐ Taiwan (TW)

3. [Optional] What is your BattleTag? *(Required to enter the drawing for a WoW Token)*

In-game Information

4. How often do you play World of Warcraft *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Daily
- ☐ Weekly
- ☐ Occasionally
- ☐ Rarely

5. During which expansion did you start playing World of Warcraft? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Classic (Vanilla)
- ☐ The Burning Crusade
- ☐ Wrath of the Lich King
- ☐ Cataclysm
- ☐ Mists of Pandaria
- ☐ Warlords of Draenor
- ☐ Legion
- ☐ Battle for Azeroth
- ☐ Shadowlands
- ☐ Dragonflight
- ☐ The War Within

6. What type of content do you typically participate in? (Select all that apply) *

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ Mythic+ Dungeons
- ☐ Normal/Heroic/Mythic 0 Dungeons
- ☐ Follower Dungeons
- ☐ Normal/Heroic/Mythic Raids
- ☐ LFR Raids
- ☐ Unrated PvP
- ☐ Solo Shuffle
- ☐ 2v2 Arena
- ☐ 3v3 Arena
- ☐ Solo Rated Battlegrounds
- ☐ 10v10 Rated Battlegrounds
- ☐ Open World PvP
- ☐ Delves
- ☐ Open World Content
- ☐ Professions
- ☐ Roleplay
- ☐ Mount/Pet Farming

7. What role do you usually play as? *

Tick all that apply.

- ☐ Tank
- ☐ Healer
- ☐ Damage

8. What type of player would you consider yourself as? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Casual
- ☐ In-between
- ☐ Hardcore

Social Play and Group Dynamics

9. How often do you play World of Warcraft with a group (e.g., friends, guildmates, pugs)? *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Never	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Always

10. Group play is important to my overall enjoyment of World of Warcraft. *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Strongly Disagree	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Strongly Agree

11. Are you currently a member of a guild? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ No

12. How many friends do you have who are actively playing World of Warcraft? *

Mark only one oval.

- ☐ None
- ☐ 1-2
- ☐ 3-5
- ☐ 6-10
- ☐ 11+

13. How often do you play with your friends or guildmates in World of Warcraft? *

Mark only one oval.

- 1 2 3 4 5
-
- Never ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Always

14. I prefer playing with my friends rather than with random players or solo. *

Mark only one oval.

- 1 2 3 4 5
-
- Strongly Disagree ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

Gameplay Preferences

15. I enjoy playing World of Warcraft. *

Mark only one oval.

- 1 2 3 4 5
-
- Strongly Disagree ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

16. I prefer solo content over multiplayer content in World of Warcraft. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

17. I like the shift towards more solo content in recent expansions (e.g., **Follower Dungeons, Delves, Torgthast, World Events**). *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

18. I find the AI companions in **Follower Dungeons** to behave realistically, similar to human players. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

19. I find the AI companions in **Delves** to behave realistically, similar to human players. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

20. I am satisfied with the current AI-driven NPCs in **Follower Dungeons**. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

21. I am satisfied with the current AI-driven NPCs in **Delves**. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

22. **Follower Dungeons** provide an enjoyable single-player experience *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

23. **Delves** provide an enjoyable single-player experience *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

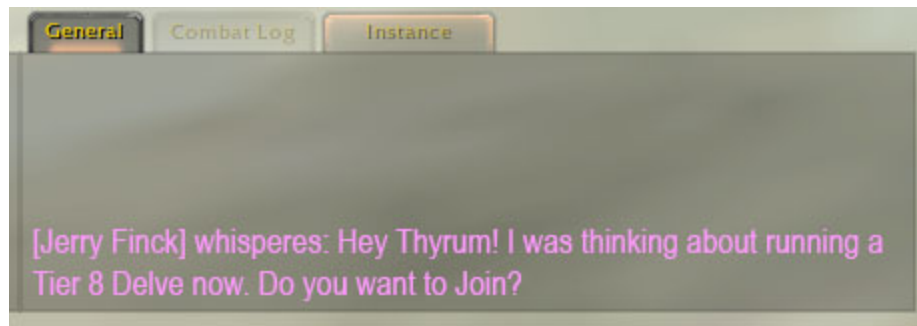
Introducing the AI-Buddy

Read this! Imagine having an AI-buddy who is always available to play with you whenever you log into World of Warcraft. This AI companion would behave like a real player, always ready to assist you with content, offer advice, and help you tackle solo challenges. You could even choose a random NPC from the game world to be your personal AI buddy, able to chat and interact with you. Your AI-buddy could also help with Follower Dungeons, Delves, and other solo content by using gear you share with them.

Chat with the NPC like you would any other player



Get invited to content



Always know where your AI-Buddy currently is



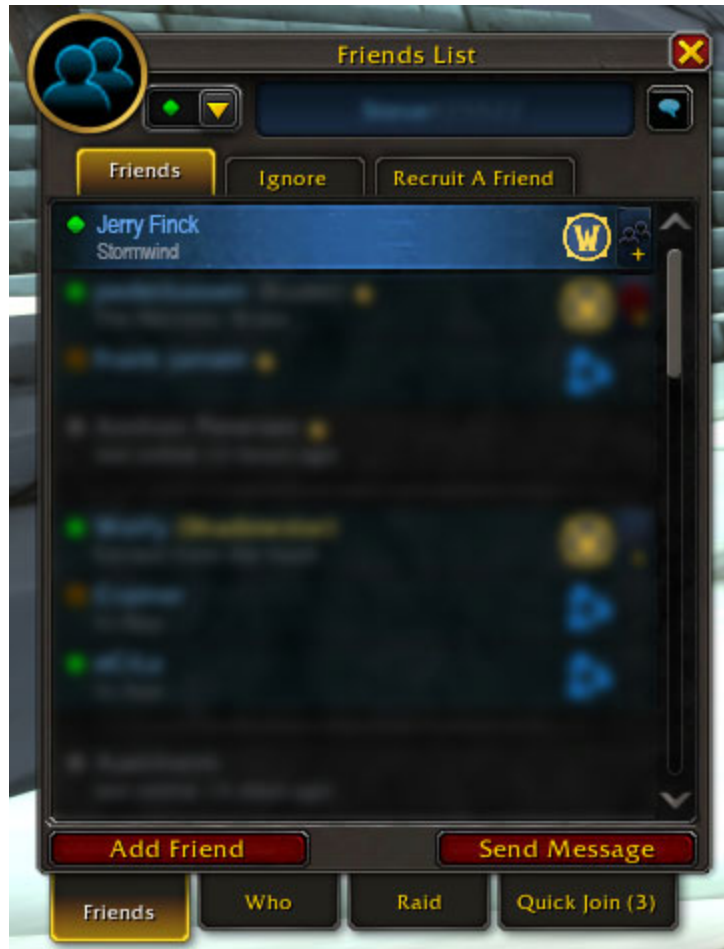
Form a friendship that will last



Listen to countless tales



Just one click away from a new party member



Gear up your AI-Buddy with gear that you won't use



AI-Buddy Interactions and Features

24. I would like my AI-buddy to learn from my behavior and improve its abilities over time. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

25. I think it would be useful for my AI-buddy to remember past interactions and adjust its responses accordingly. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

26. I believe my AI-buddy should provide personalized tips based on my performance in dungeons, raids, or battlegrounds. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

27. I think it would be beneficial for my AI-buddy to take on specific roles (e.g., healer, tank, DPS) based on my group composition or solo needs. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

28. I would like my AI-buddy to help with managing inventory or gathering resources (e.g., farming materials, completing professions). *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

29. I believe my AI-buddy should be able to assist in world PvP. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Strongly Agree

30. I think it would be useful if my AI-buddy could suggest in-game activities based on my interests or current progress. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Strongly Agree

31. I would like my AI-buddy to offer moral support or positive feedback after completing difficult content (e.g., raids, Mythic+, battlegrounds). *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Strongly Agree

32. I would appreciate the option to change my AI-buddy's appearance (e.g., gear, looks, race) to make them more personalized. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Strongly Agree

AI-Buddy Behavior and Customization

33. I would prefer my AI-buddy to have a customizable personality (e.g., playful, serious, strategic). *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

34. I believe it would be important for my AI-buddy to respond to in-game events (e.g., commenting on zone changes, lore events, or holiday activities). *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

35. I think my AI-buddy should be able to initiate conversations with me when I am idle in the game world. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

36. I would like my AI-buddy to share stories or lore from World of Warcraft, enhancing the immersion of the game world. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

Impact on Gameplay

37. I believe that having an AI-buddy would enhance my immersion in the game. *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Stro	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Strongly Agree

38. I would like my AI-buddy to take part in dynamic world events (e.g., world quests, open world content). *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Stro	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Strongly Agree

39. I think an AI-buddy could help reduce feelings of loneliness when playing solo. *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Stro	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Strongly Agree

40. I believe that an AI-buddy could improve the quality of solo content in World of Warcraft. *

Mark only one oval.

	1	2	3	4	5	
Stro	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	Strongly Agree

41. I would like my AI-buddy to help me with repetitive content (e.g., farming materials, reputation grinds). *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

AI-buddy and Social Dynamics

42. I am concerned that AI buddies could reduce the need for player interaction in group content. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

43. I believe AI buddies should have limitations on which content they can assist with (e.g., only in solo or non-competitive group content). *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

44. I would be interested in having my AI-buddy participate in role playing scenarios. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

45. I believe an AI-buddy should be distinguishable from real players to avoid confusion in group content. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

46. I would use AI-buddy when my friends are unavailable to play. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

47. I would still prefer playing with friends, even if AI-buddy were available to help with content. *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

48. I think the AI-buddy could be a good addition to World of Warcraft *

Mark only one oval.

1 2 3 4 5

Stro ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ ☐ Strongly Agree

Additional Feedback

49. What concerns, if any, do you have about the introduction of AI-driven NPCs in World of Warcraft?

50. Do you have any other suggestions or features you'd like to see in an AI-buddy?

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